

Ward Infrastructure

Player-facing description

The whole visible system of stones, spires, chimes, contracts, and keepers that makes the frontier feel safe.

Public role

The protective, financial, and soul-signal system behind the one-shot

Handout text

Player-safe note: The full stack of wardstones, relay spires, contracts, maintenance, soul-power, security response, insurance, and public narrative.

GM truth

The ward network is also an economy: construction, soul-power, security, finance, retail protection, and propaganda all feed from the same danger.

GM handling

Use when the scene needs a concrete object for players to inspect, carry, debate, or remember.

Mechanics

- Title: Discovery / Earn-It Mechanics
- Player Safe: Players can inspect, handle, keep, trade, reveal, or earn Ward Infrastructure when it is present in the fiction.
- Gm Only: Use the roll only when the player's method, stakes, and consequence are concrete.
- No Roll Reveals: Surface read: The full stack of wardstones, relay spires, contracts, maintenance, soul-power, security response, insurance, and public narrative. Give obvious visible facts freely; roll for meaning, risk, leverage, cost, or a hidden angle.
- Rolls: entity-ward-infrastructure-engage-ward-infrastructure entity-ward-infrastructure Engage Ward Infrastructure Engage Ward Infrastructure Knowledge Finesse Instinct Presence Knowledge Finesse, Instinct, Presence 12 Choose the trait from the player's method, not the entity type. A flat read of Ward Infrastructure hides the cost, motive, or useful next step. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains

Fear...

- Fear Spends: Reveal who benefits from the current situation. Make the cost personal without closing off player agency.
- Condition Options: No official condition unless the item or clue physically creates Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable
- Search Loot: Infrastructure is not loot; it is the map of who profits from danger and who pays when protection fails.

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